Protecting freedom and human rights

What are EU citizens not permitted to do?

In other EU Member States:

a.) reside for longer than 12 months.

b.) open a business.

c.) participate in national elections.

Answer: Participating in national elections. The right to vote in national elections remains tied to the respective citizenship. However, EU citizens possess the right to vote in local elections within the Member States.

Protecting freedom and human rights

Discrimination is prohibited in the EU.

What forms of discrimination do you know?

Name at least three.

Answer: Gender, origin/ethnic background, religion or worldview, age, disability, sexual orientation

Protecting freedom and human rights

How can the EU combat discrimination?

Discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Protecting freedom and human rights

Answer: E.g., anti-discrimination laws, support programs, awareness-raising and education, support for NGOs, sanctions for violations.

In a Member State, minorities are being discriminated against. Is this an internal matter or an EU issue?

Discuss this amongst yourselves for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: Although the specific design of minority policy—such as the definition of national minorities or language regulations—lies largely within the national responsibility of the Member States, the European legal framework sets clear limits. Discrimination is, therefore, always a European issue as well.

Protecting freedom and human rights

What prize did the EU receive for its efforts on behalf of peace, reconciliation, democracy, and human rights in Europe?

Answer: Nobel Peace Prize. In 2012, the EU was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for its efforts to promote peace, reconciliation, democracy, and human rights in Europe. At the time, the EU decided to increase the prize money—amounting to 930,000 euros—to two million euros and to dedicate it to children unable to grow up in peace.

Protecting freedom and human rights

How many letters does the longest place name in Europe have?

a.) 42

b.) 58

c.) 76

d.) 63

Protecting freedom and human rights

Answer: The longest place name in Europe is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwytndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch. It is located in Wales, in the United Kingdom, and has 58 letters.

Which of the following values is not one of the fundamental values of the EU?

a.) Human dignity

b.) Rule of law

c.) Economic growth

d.) Equality

Protecting freedom and human rights

Answer: Economic growth

What do the 12 stars on the EU flag stand for?

a.) The unity and harmony among the peoples of Europe

b.) The 12 founding states

c.) The 12 Carolingian emperors

d.) The 12 months of the year

Answer: For unity and harmony among the European peoples. Indeed, the number 12 traditionally stands for perfection and unity (e.g., twelve months, twelve signs of the zodiac). Therefore, the number of 12 golden stars was chosen to symbolize the harmony among the peoples of Europe.

Protecting freedom and human rights

Which value is referred to as the actual foundation of the EU?

a.) Freedom

b.) Rule of law

c.) Human dignity

d.) Democracy

Protecting freedom and human rights

Answer*:* Human dignity constitutes the supreme foundation and starting point of all fundamental rights of the European Union. Enshrined in the Treaty on European Union, it is inviolable and lies at the heart of the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union, which upholds all the values, freedoms, and rights of EU citizens. This foundation guarantees that the EU is not merely an economic bloc, but a community of values that places the protection and full development of every individual at the center of its political and legal action.

Protecting freedom and human rights

Protecting freedom and human rights

Strengthen democracy

Did you vote in the European elections?

What motivates or discourages you?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Strengthen demoracy

What is the aim of the EU's enlargement policy?

a.) Economic growth alone

b.) Strengthening stability, democracy and peace in Europe

c.) Expanding military power

d.) Reducing trade with Asia

Answer: Strengthening stability, democracy and peace in Europe

Strengthen democracy

Has your view of the EU changed over the course of your life?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Strengthen democracy

True or false:

Citizens can use a European Citizens' Initiative to propose new EU laws.

Answer: True (at least 1 million signatures from several Member States are required)

Strengthen demoracy

How can we influence political decisions in the EU?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: E.g. by voting in European and local elections, getting involved in NGOs, European citizens' initiatives and political parties, contributing to political discussions and on social media platforms, and submitting and supporting petitions to the European Parliament.

Strengthen democracy

How can you help to protect democracy?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: E.g., voting, demonstrating civic courage, engagement in civil society, political participation, media literacy, volunteering.

Strengthen democracy

In one country, court rulings are being ignored.

Should the EU:

a.) Stay out of it?

b.) Hold talks?

c.) Cut funding?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: "Staying out of it" is not an option for the EU, as this would undermine both the Single Market and the Union of Values. As a general rule, discussions are held first. If breaches of the rule of law jeopardize the EU's financial interests (e.g., through corruption or a lack of an independent judiciary), EU funds may be frozen. This measure was applied, for instance, in the case of Hungary.

Strengthen demoracy

How many different recipes are there for the Portuguese speciality 'Bacalhau' (salted cod)?

a.) Exactly 12 (one for every month)

b.) Over 50 regional variations

c.) Exactly 100 traditional ways of preparing it

d.) 365 – one for every day of the year

Answer: In Portugal, it is said that there are at least 365 recipes for bacalhau, so you can enjoy it differently every day.

Strengthen democracy

Which European city has more bridges than Venice?

a.) Prague

b.) Hamburg

c.) Amsterdam

d.) Stockholm

Answer: Hamburg has over 2,500 bridges – more than Venice, Amsterdam and London put together.

Strengthen democracy

Strengthen demoracy

Strengthen democracy

Living in solidarity

What should the EU spend more money on?

a.) on joint EU projects in which everyone participates

b.) on projects in economically disadvantaged regions, so that living standards there improve?

c.) instead of spending money, stop taking money from EU countries

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: A third of the EU budget is spent on projects that benefit all cities and regions in the EU. – The majority of the funds goes to less developed regions.

Living in solidarity

What are the benefits of living in the EU?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: E.g., EU-wide consumer protection, freedom of movement within the EU; the ability to live, work, study, and retire anywhere in the EU.

Living in solidarity

Do you know of any examples of European solidarity?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: E.g., COVID-19 relief, disaster relief, flood relief

Living in solidarity

Which European programme specifically promotes exchange and understanding between young people?

a.) Horizon Europe

b.) Erasmus+

c.) Europol

d.) Frontex

Answer: Erasmus+ is the EU program for supporting education and training, youth, and sport. Horizon Europe is the EU program for research and innovation. Europol supports Member States in preventing and combating all forms of serious international and organized crime, cybercrime, and terrorism. Frontex is the EU agency for border and coast guard operations. Frontex has faced criticism for turning people away at borders without giving them the opportunity to apply for asylum.

Living in solidarity

What is the EU's official motto?

a.) Together we are strong

b.) United in diversity

c.) Together rather than alone

Answer: The motto expresses the fact that EU member states work together to promote peace and prosperity, whilst preserving Europe's cultural diversity.

Living in solidarity

What is the aim of EU structural funding?

a.) Military cooperation

b.) Reducing regional disparities

c.) Harmonising taxes

Answer: EU structural funding provides financial support to regions across Europe through various funds, with the aim of reducing economic and social inequalities and promoting sustainable development. Examples include education, social inclusion, sustainable management and urban development, digitalisation, and many more.

Living in solidarity

Is the EU obliged to bear the debt of an EU Member State?

Yes or no?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: There is no direct, legally binding obligation to assume another person's debts within the EU.

Living in solidarity

What unusual event takes place every year near Valencia in Spain?

a.) A marathon in which participants carry olive oil

b.) A swimming race against trained bulls

c.) A massive tomato fight ('La Tomatina')

d.) A competition to build towers out of cheese wheels

Answer: The "La Tomatina" festival in Buñol, near Valencia, is world-famous; during the event, thousands of people throw overripe tomatoes at one another.

Living in solidarity

Which country has the most islands in Europe?

a.) Greece

b.) Norway

c.) Sweden

d.) Italy

Answer: Sweden has over 260,000 islands!

Living in solidarity

Living in solidarity

Living in solidarity

Climate action and sustainable practices

What is the EU's main current objective in the field of climate protection?

a.) Promoting nuclear energy in all Member States

b.) Introducing a uniform environmental tax

c.) Phasing out fossil fuels by 2030

d.) Achieving climate neutrality by 2050

Answer: The EU has legally committed to becoming the first major economy to be climate-neutral by 2050. This means that net greenhouse gas emissions are to be reduced to zero, and any remaining emissions are to be offset by natural sinks or technologies.

Climate action and sustainable practices

What is the name of the EU's major climate action programme?

a.) European Green Future

b.) Green Europe

c.) Green Day

Answer: The "European Green Deal" (EGD) is an EU initiative adopted in 2019. The objective of these measures is to achieve climate neutrality in Europe by 2050. By 2030, greenhouse gas emissions are to be reduced by 55%. The EGD aims to foster sustainable growth and integrates social, environmental, and economic factors. It thus constitutes a significant contribution to the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and the Paris Agreement, and positions Europe as a global frontrunner. In terms of development policy, the EGD encompasses key initiatives in the areas of climate protection and climate change adaptation, renewable energies, biodiversity, the circular economy, deforestation-free supply chains, and sustainable food production .

Climate action and sustainable practices

d.) European Green Deal

Why is achieving carbon neutrality by 2050 important?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: E.g., to protect the climate, to prevent natural disasters, and to safeguard future generations.

Climate action and sustainable practices

What would be/are the consequences if climate targets are not met?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: For example, more extreme weather, economic damage, health problems, social conflicts, higher costs in the future.

Climate action and sustainable practices

What can each of us do to help protect the climate?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: For example: saving energy, using public transport, buying second-hand (mobile phones, clothes), saving water and energy at home, buying local and seasonal produce, consuming mindfully.

Climate action and sustainable practices

Can I stream my favourite TV series for free in Portugal?

Yes or no?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: Yes. Roaming has been available in the EU since 2017, meaning that mobile phone customers in the EU, as well as in Iceland, Liechtenstein and Norway, can use their mobile phones on the same terms as they do at home.

Climate action and sustainable practices

Climate action and sustainable practices

Climate action and sustainable practices

Protecting of peace and security

What role does the EU play in international conflicts?

a.) Military operations only

b.) Diplomacy, civilian missions and, in some cases, military missions

c.) Economic sanctions only

d.) No role

Answer: Diplomacy, civilian missions and, in some cases, military missions.

Protecting of peace and security

Without the EU, there would probably be more wars in Europe today.

Is that true?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: While the EU is not a guarantor of absolute peace, it has created a structure that has made wars between member states unlikely. Without this political and economic integration, Europe would, in all likelihood, be more unstable and susceptible to national conflicts.

Protecting of peace and security

What is one of the main tasks of Frontex, the European Border and Coast Guard Agency?

a.) Managing EU accession negotiations

b.) Securing the EU's external borders

c.) Allocating development aid to third countries

d.) Organising cultural exchange programmes

Answer: Securing the EU's external borders. Frontex faces criticism because people are turned away at the borders without having the opportunity to apply for asylum.

Protecting of peace and security

When did the era of hostility between France and Germany come to an end?

a.) 1945

b.) 1959

c.) 1963

d.) 1968

Answer: The Élysée Treaty was signed on January 22, 1963, by Federal Chancellor Konrad Adenauer and President Charles de Gaulle, sealing the reconciliation between Germany and France. It established a close friendship and mandated regular consultations on foreign, security, and cultural policy, thereby putting an end to the historic enmity.

Protecting of peace and security

Why do sheep often have unofficial right of way in Ireland?

a.) In Ireland, sheep are considered sacred animals that bring good luck.

b.) There are twice as many sheep as people (around 8 million).

c.) The Irish Constitution protects grazing animals from cars honking their horns.

d.) Sheep are trained to direct traffic in villages.

Answer: Due to the huge population of around 8 million animals, encounters on the road are so common that drivers usually have to wait patiently.

Protecting of peace and security

In which European country is chess a compulsory subject in many schools?

a.) Hungary

b.) Armenia

c.) Romania

d.) Bulgaria

Answer: Since 2011, chess has been a compulsory subject in primary schools in Armenia.

Protecting of peace and security

What role does the UNHCR (United Nations Refugee Agency) play in the EU?

a.) Provides on-the-ground assistance in crisis situations by supplying essential supplies

b.) Provides information and education on issues relating to displacement and asylum

c.) Protects and supports people worldwide who are fleeing

Answer: All the answers are correct.

Protecting of peace and security

What are the objectives of the EU's new refugee policy?

a.) Asylum centres at external borders

b.) Faster deportations

c.) Strict border management

d.) A decline in asylum applications

Answer: All the answers are correct.

Protecting of peace and security

What is the reason for this development, and where have the biggest changes taken place?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer*:* In June 2022, Cyprus hosted 70.7 refugees and asylum seekers per 1,000 inhabitants.
By comparison: Poland hosted 32.2, Germany 29.7, and Latvia 18.8.
By the end of 2024, 123.2 million people worldwide were displaced—an increase of 6% compared to 2023. Of these, 42.7 million were classified as recognized refugees in the strict sense. Europe's share of the global refugee population rose from under 10% to around 20% as a result of Russia's war of aggression against Ukraine.

Protecting economy and domestic market

Is that real feta or just cheese with a touch of wanderlust? Which cheese is allowed to be called feta?

a.) Goat's milk cheese from Greece

b.) Sheep's milk cheese from Greece

c.) Goat's milk cheese from France

d.) Sheep's milk cheese from France

Answer: Feta may contain a maximum of 30 per cent goat's milk – the rest must be sheep's milk. Furthermore, Feta is subject to a Protected Designation of Origin and is therefore legally protected throughout Europe, which means that the milk must come from animals living either on the Greek mainland or on Lesbos.

Protecting economy and domestic market

What does freedom of movement within the EU mean?

a.) The right to travel to any country in the world without a visa.

b.) The right to vote in national elections in any EU country.

c.) The right to live and work in any EU country as you would in your home country.

d.) The right to apply for asylum in any EU country.

Answer: The right to live and work in any country just as one would in one's home country.

Protecting economy and domestic market

What are the benefits of the euro?

Please discuss this for a maximum of 2 minutes.

Answer: For example, no need to exchange currency in many countries, easier price comparisons, greater economic stability, an.d easier trade

Protecting economy and domestic market

What are the minimum length and thickness requirements for a banana to be imported into the EU?

a.) Length 11 cm, thickness 30 mm

b.) Length 16 cm, thickness 36 mm

c.) Length 14 cm, thickness 27 mm

d.) Length 9 cm, thickness 25 mm

Answer: Minimum length: 14 cm (measured along the convex side from the flower to the base of the stem).

Minimum thickness: 27 mm (measured at the thickest point).

Protecting economy and domestic market

What does the CE mark on products mean?

a.) Complicated Europe

b.) Central Europe

c.) Conformité Européenne

d.) Common Era

Answer: Conformité Européenne = EU compliance: The product meets EU safety standards. Protects against dangerous products. EU consumer protection is a world leader.

Protecting economy and domestic market

Where is the main production facility for the famous Playmobil figures located?

a.) In Zirndorf, Germany

b.) On the island of Malta

c.) In Billund, Denmark

d.) In the French Alps

Answer: Although Playmobil is a German brand, the figures have been manufactured in Malta since the 1970s; around 100 million figures leave the island every year.

Protecting economy and domestic market

Which unusual world championship is held regularly in Finland?

a.) The World Mobile Phone Throwing Championship

b.) The International Reindeer Synchronised Swimming Championship

c.) A race in backwards snowshoeing

d.) The Championship in Endurance Sauna-Sitting at 120 degrees

Answer: Finland is known for its quirky sports; mobile phone throwing was established there as an official sport in 2000.

Protecting economy and domestic market

In which country is the world's northernmost McDonald's located?

a.) Norway

b.) Finland

c.) Iceland

d.) Sweden

Answer: Finland – in the town of Rovaniemi, near the Arctic Circle.

Protecting economy and domestic market

Which organisation supports cooperation between police authorities in Europe?

a.) Europol

b.) UNESCO

c.) Interpol

d.) Council of Europe

Protecting economy and domestic market

Answer*:* Europol assists in the fight against all forms of international and organized crime, cybercrime, and terrorism. As a global platform, Interpol connects the police authorities of 196 member states to combat cross-border crime. The objectives of the Council of Europe are the defense and protection of human rights, democracy, and the rule of law in Europe. UNESCO is the United Nations organization for education, science, culture, and communication.

Protecting economy and domestic market

Protecting economy and domestic market